D H A R

# Volume III — Ecosystem, Trust & Adoption

# CASTING DHAR

*“Cast far enough, and it reaches people who were never going to come looking for it.”*

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| **Part of** | The Canon of Dhar, Volume III |
| **Depends on** | Spec0 §2.1, Stage-delta §3 (Kun) |
| **Audience** | Education partners, policymakers, developer relations |

# 1. Mandate

Make Dhar something Nigerian and African developers actually encounter, learn, and choose — not a language that exists only inside this Canon. Spec0 §2.1 states the motivation; this document turns it into a plan evaluated against institutions and programs that already exist, not invented from nothing. Every claim below is checked against a real, currently operating initiative; where this Canon could not verify a specific fact, it says so rather than filling the gap with something that sounds right.

# 2. Education & Curriculum Integration

## 2.1 A module inside 3MTT, not a program competing with it

Nigeria's 3 Million Technical Talent programme (3MTT), launched by the Federal Ministry of Communications, Innovation & Digital Economy with NITDA in late 2023, is already the largest structure of its kind in the country: Phase 1 trained 31,270 fellows across all 36 states and the FCT against a 30,000 target, Phase 2 is running 300,000 fellows through three cohorts, and the programme reports over 135,000 people trained directly with more than 300,000 additional learners reached through community platforms. It already runs a Software Development track and a Cybersecurity track, and it already solves the distribution problem — reach, government backing, a talent registry connecting graduates to jobs — that a new program would otherwise have to build from zero.

The realistic strategy is therefore not a competing “Dhar Academy,” but a Dhar module contributed into 3MTT's existing Software Development and Cybersecurity tracks: a short, self-contained unit built around the same bootstrap story this Canon itself tells — lexer, parser, type checker, code generator, self-hosting — which is a real compilers curriculum, not a marketing exercise, and doubles as a demonstration of the memory-safety guarantees Tempering Dhar specifies.

## 2.2 University & polytechnic partnerships

This Canon does not name specific institutions here, since doing so without a confirmed partnership would be exactly the kind of unverified claim §1 rules out. The model instead: an elective module or a compilers-course project pack (Stage-alpha's bootstrap pipeline is a ready-made syllabus), offered to computer science and computer engineering departments, with final-year and postgraduate project sponsorship (implementing a Stage-delta standard-library module, or a new backend per Spec0 §4, are both real, scoped, publishable research problems, not busywork).

## 2.3 Why Dhar fits as a second language, not a first

Spec1's explicit typing and systems-level constructs (§12–14: view/grab/own, raw memory) assume the learner already has a first language's worth of programming concepts. The concise/explicit split Spec1 §4.3–4.4 specifies (inferred by default, explicit when it matters, wild when genuinely dynamic) is deliberately built so that a learner arriving from Python or JavaScript reads Dhar's concise form immediately, then grows into the explicit, systems-level form as the course does — matching how 3MTT's own tracks are sequenced rather than requiring a learner to restart from zero.

# 3. Pan-African Reach

## 3.1 Smart Africa as the distribution structure, not a new one

Smart Africa, founded in 2013 by seven heads of state and endorsed by the African Union in 2014, now spans roughly 40 member states representing over a billion people, with a stated vision of a Single Digital Market in Africa by 2030. The African Union's own Digital Transformation Strategy for Africa 2020–2030, which Smart Africa implements, states as an explicit objective ensuring “Africa's ownership of modern tools of digital management” — language that could be lifted directly from Spec0 §2.1 and was written without any knowledge of this project. The pan-African strategy this Canon commits to is aligning with that existing structure's digital-skills and e-governance workstreams rather than building a country-by-country outreach effort from scratch; a continent-wide alliance already exists and already has the mandate.

## 3.2 Hardware & connectivity reality

A meaningful share of the continent's developers work on older, lower-specification hardware and less consistent power and connectivity than the markets most developer tooling is designed against by default. This Canon records it as a design requirement, not an afterthought: Kun (Stage-delta §3.3) must resolve and reuse a lockfile entirely from local cache with no network round-trip when nothing has changed, and dhar build's resource footprint should be a stated, tracked property of every stage release, not something discovered late. A toolchain that only runs comfortably on well-resourced machines has quietly narrowed “independence” (Spec0 §2.2) to whoever can already afford it.

# 4. Government & Industry Partnerships

| Body | What it actually is | Where Dhar plugs in |
|---|---|---|
| NITDA (National Information Technology Development Agency, Nigeria) | Nigeria's federal IT policy and standards agency; co-runs 3MTT with the Ministry of Communications, Innovation & Digital Economy. | The natural first point of contact for a 3MTT curriculum module (§2.1) and for any future national digital-sovereignty framing of Spec0's mission. |
| 3MTT | Active national training programme, 12 tracks including Software Development and Cybersecurity; already past its Phase 1 target. | Direct curriculum integration, §2.1. |
| Smart Africa Alliance | ~40-member-state pan-African digital policy alliance, AU-endorsed. | Distribution and policy alignment across borders, §3.1, without a separate country-by-country effort. |

## 5. Developer Relations & Community Growth

- Hackathons scoped around real Stage-delta gaps (a new std.collections method, a Kun registry feature) rather than generic build-anything events — a hackathon that produces a merged contribution is worth more than one that produces a demo.
- A public showcase of real Kun packages, updated as they appear, functioning as both social proof and a map of where the ecosystem still has gaps — the same showcase doubles as an honest to-do list.
- "Good first issue" labeling and a mentorship pairing for first-time contributors, owned procedurally by The Guild of Dhar once written, referenced here rather than duplicated (Master Index §3.6).

## 6. Success Metrics

Proposed here for The Pact of Developing Dhar (Volume IV) to formalize, deliberately avoiding vanity metrics that measure attention rather than adoption:

- 3MTT fellows completing the Dhar module, and how many go on to publish a Kun package.
- University courses using the bootstrap pipeline as course material, and student projects that extend a Stage-delta module or backend.
- Published, non-trivial Kun packages (excluding placeholder/example packages) and their download counts over time.
- Countries with an active local user group or meetup, tracked against Smart Africa's own member-state list as the realistic ceiling.
- Government or institutional pilot deployments — the single metric that most directly validates Spec0 §5's defence and critical-infrastructure ambition.

## 7. Relationship to Other Volumes

| This document assumes | Ratified in |
|---|---|
| The founding motivation this strategy serves | Spec0 §2.1 |
| Kun's offline-friendly resolution requirement (§3.2) | Stage-delta §3.3 |
| Community/contribution mechanics referenced in §5 | The Guild of Dhar (not yet written) |
| Formal adoption metrics (§6) | The Pact of Developing Dhar (not yet written) |

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